



## Brown fur seal

### *Arctocephalus pusillus*

- ↔ 6–8 ft (1.8–2.4 m)
- 📍 Southern Africa, SE. Australia
- ⊗ Locally common

Like all fur seals and sea lions, brown fur seals have powerful forelimbs and long hindlimbs that can be rotated forward. This allows them to walk on all fours on land, unlike the more fishlike true seals. They gather on rocky shores in colonies of a thousand or more during the breeding season. The males are bigger than the females, and compete to secure territories that give them control over harems of females.

## South American sea lion

### *Otaria byronia*

- ↔ 8–9 ft (2.4–2.8 m)
- 📍 W., S., and E. South America, Falkland Islands
- ⊗ Common

This species is probably the original “sea lion”—the male has a huge head with a luxuriant mane and weighs twice as much as the female. As with other sea lions and fur seals, the biggest males fight to control as many females as possible. South American sea lions favor sandy beaches for resting and breeding, and go out to sea to prey on fish, squid, and the occasional seabird. The mothers coax their



pups into the water after 1–2 months, which is a relatively early age for a sea lion.

## California sea lion

### *Zalophus californianus*

- ↔ Up to 2.4 m (7<sup>3</sup>/<sub>4</sub> ft)
- 📍 W. US
- ⊗ Locally common



Ranging from Alaska to Mexico, the California sea lion is far more widespread than its name suggests. It preys mainly on squid and shoaling fish such as herring, catching them on short dives to depths of about 75 m (245 ft). This species rarely strays more than 16 km (10 miles) out to sea and often enters harbours and estuaries for food and shelter. Compared to the sleek females, the males are bigger and generally darker, with more robust forequarters, which prove useful during territorial disputes. The juveniles are a uniform tan color.



## Humboldt's hog-nosed skunk

### *Conepatus humboldtii*

- ↔ 10–15 in (25–38 cm)
- 📍 S. South America
- ⊗ Locally common

Named for its piglike naked nose pad, adapted for rooting in the ground for insects, this skunk is black or reddish brown with a prominent white stripe extending along each flank, from its crown to its bushy tail. Solitary and nocturnal, it spends the day hidden in a burrow or a den beneath rocks. Like other skunks, it can defend itself with a foul-smelling spray.

## Eastern spotted skunk

### *Spilogale putorius*

- ↔ 12–14 in (30–36 cm)
- 📍 E. to C. US, NE. Mexico
- ⊗ Common

Smaller and sleeker than the more familiar striped skunk, the eastern spotted skunk has a similar pattern of black-and-white fur, broken up into large patches that vary from one individual to another. The striking pattern warns predators to leave it alone, or risk being sprayed with a noxious fluid from its anal glands. It has a mixed diet of small animals, bird eggs, and fruit.

## Palawan stink badger

### *Mydaus marchei*

- ↔ 14–18 in (36–46 cm)
- 📍 Philippines (Palawan and Busuanga Islands)
- ⊗ Locally common

Genetic studies show that this stocky, badgerlike animal belongs to the same family as the skunks, which accounts for its ability to drive off its enemies with a pungent secretion squirted from its anal scent glands. It uses its long, flexible, almost hairless snout to probe for small animals in the soil and lives alone in a rocky den or abandoned burrow.